

Pea Soup

This simple pea soup recipe makes an elegant start to a spring meal. It's also a great way to use frozen vegetables when the produce section is looking bleak.

By **Carolyn Malcoun** | Updated on August 2, 2025

✔ Reviewed by Dietitian **Christa Brown, M.S., RDN, LD**

Active Time: 35 mins

Total Time: 35 mins

Servings: 4

Yield: 4 servings, about 2 cups each

Nutrition Profile:

Nut-Free Healthy Aging Healthy Immunity Soy-Free High-Fiber High-Protein Egg-Free Gluten-Free Low-Calorie

Ingredients

1 tablespoon butter

1 tablespoon extra-virgin olive oil

1 medium onion, chopped

1 stalk celery, chopped

2 cloves garlic, chopped

1 teaspoon chopped fresh thyme or parsley

6 cups peas, fresh or frozen

½ cup water

4 cups reduced-sodium chicken broth, “no-chicken” broth (see Note) or vegetable broth

½ cup half-and-half (optional)

½ teaspoon salt

¼ teaspoon freshly ground pepper, to taste

Directions

Step 1

Heat butter and oil in a Dutch oven over medium heat until the butter melts. Add onion and celery; cook, stirring occasionally, until softened, 4 to 6 minutes. Add garlic and thyme (or parsley); cook, stirring, until fragrant, about 10 seconds.

Step 2

Stir in peas. Add water and broth; bring to a lively simmer over high heat. Reduce heat to maintain a lively simmer and cook until very tender, about 1 minute.

Step 3

Puree the soup in batches in a countertop blender or with an immersion blender until smooth. (Use caution when pureeing hot liquids.) Stir in half-and-half (if using), salt and pepper.

Equipment

Dutch oven, countertop blender or immersion blender

Frequently Asked Questions

Is this recipe gluten-free?



Yes, since this recipe has no ingredients containing gluten, it is gluten-free.

Is pea soup vegetarian?



It can be! While chicken broth offers a rich, savory flavor, using a vegetarian “no-chicken” broth is a good alternative. This chicken-flavored broth, a vegetarian broth despite its name, is preferable to vegetable broth in this recipe for its hearty, rich flavor and light golden color that won’t dull the color of the soup. Look for “no-chicken” broth with the soups and broths in the natural-foods section of most supermarkets.

Can I make pea soup ahead?



Yes! Refrigerate pea soup in an airtight container for up to 4 days or freeze for up to 3 months.

Originally appeared: EatingWell Magazine, Soup Cookbook

Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size about 2 cups** 287 calories; total fat 9g; saturated fat 3g; cholesterol 8mg; sodium 384mg; total carbohydrate 38g; dietary fiber 13g; total sugars 14g; protein 17g; vitamin c 90mg; calcium 80mg; iron 4mg; potassium 813mg

Additional reporting by Carrie Myers, M.S., Hilary Meyer, *and* Sara Haas, RDN, LDN

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